

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

What should I write in the User Manual?



Learning Outcome:

Designs a user manual that fulfills both the IT solution needs and the client requirements.

Understand how to write a good user manual.

Can Do Statements:

- I can explain how to give instructions and how to design individual pages in the user manual.
- I can describe how to create a physical manual.

Ask your partner:

- What information do you think should be written in manuals?
- How do you think manuals should look like? Why?





Let's Explore!

Noah and Ava are at a class learning how to design a user manual.



Instructions: Read the text below.

Teacher: Let's wrap up what we've been studying lately. If you want to design a user manual, how should one give instructions, and what should one bear in mind?

Noah: If you want to make sure your users get it right, you shouldn't assume they know information you already know. You should also set your aim clear and let the user know your objective.

Ava: You need to make it easy to understand too, avoiding patronizing and confusing font styles.

Teacher: What about the design itself? The physical product?

Noah: The user manual should fit the size; if your product isn't too big, you should watch the proportions.

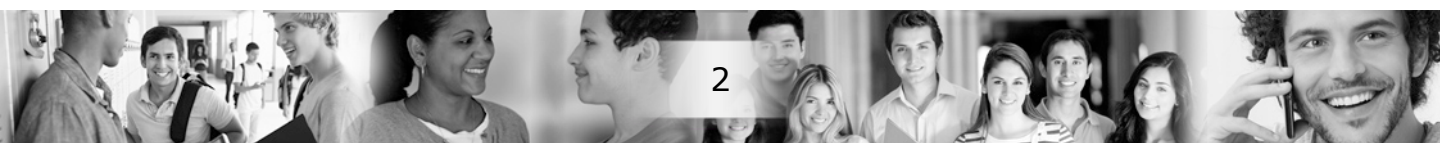
Ava: It is important you also consider the type of paper you use for the manual; it could be something resistant and eye-catching. Try not to overwhelm the user with lots of information they might feel useless. Pictures and diagrams could also be good visual aids to keep the style on the pages.

Noah: Creators could try to draw users' attention from the very beginning by implementing large-sized fonts to highlight important aspects. I believe most users don't get to read the manuals, only if they must; thus, it could be a good opportunity to connect better with customers.

Teacher: What are some other aspects to consider when creating the hardcopy of the manual?

Ava: You should provide enough space between sections to avoid confusion and use color coding if necessary. You should also consider where the manual will be used, and if it needs to be resistant to water, oil, or dirt.

Noah: Users will probably prefer durable covers and pages to make sure the manual can lie flat when it is open.





Let's Practice!

The characteristics of a good user manual.

Instructions: Circle the correct answer.

1. What is the purpose of not assuming that your readers know the same you do?
 - a. So you could write instructions for anyone to be able to understand.
 - b. So you could express instructions for anyone to understand.
 - c. So you could read the instructions and understand them.
 - d. So you could write expressions for anyone to understand.
2. How could it be a good manual?
 - a. It could be long so people get bored.
 - b. It could be extremely simple so it doesn't even work.
 - c. It could be everything but simple so people must think hard.
 - d. Neither too long nor too simple, it must be clear so everyone could understand.
3. Why is it important to add pictures and diagrams?
 - a. So you could inform the characteristics of the user to the product.
 - b. So information is basically useless for the user.
 - c. So you could make the user understand easily how the product works.
 - d. So the product could be partially understood by the user.
4. What could be the purpose of a user manual?
 - a. It could be a tool for the user to understand the instructions and the way to use the product.
 - b. It could be the part of the product that is understandable by the designer.
 - c. It could be a book for the user to understand the designer ideas.
 - d. It could be a tool for the designer to show how he bears in mind his products.



Let's Practice!

The aim of a user manual.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentence.

1. readers. / the / be / between / for / confusing / enough / space / it / If / could / didn't / sections, / provide / you

2. draw / will / you / using / fonts, / attention / If / they / users' / lose / large-sized / interest. / don't

3. visual / a / you / aids, / you / If / pages. / on / keep / the / good / implement / style





Extension Activity

Comparing manuals

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Find two manuals of a same kind of product, for example a TV.
- Read and compare both manuals.
- Make a chart showing the similarities and differences between both manuals.
- Share your findings with your classmates.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

- I find two manuals of a same kind of product.
- I read and compare them.
- I make a chart showing the similarities and differences between the manuals.
- I share my findings with my classmates.

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Target Words

- aim** (noun): goal or objective.
e.g. You should also set your aim clear and let the user know your objective.
- fit** (verb): to be proper or appropriate for something.
e.g. The user manual should fit the size; if your product isn't too big, you should watch the proportions.
- patronize** (verb): to act in an arrogant way.
e.g. You need to make it easy to understand too, avoiding patronizing and confusing font styles.
- set** (verb): to establish or apply something.
e.g. You should also set your aim clear and let the user know your objective.
- visual aid** (noun): an object used to illustrate or exemplify.
e.g. Pictures and diagrams could also be good visual aids to keep the style on the pages.
- wrap up** (phrasal verb): to summarize or conclude.
e.g. Let's wrap up what we've been studying lately.



Learning Points

Modal Verbs for Speculating - Could

Modal verbs help us expressing different intentions when we talk; obligation, permission, possibility, ability, advice or prohibition.

You can use **could** when you want to make guesses or speculate about a particular event, in this case, we call them **modal verbs for speculating**.

You can use the **modal verbs of speculation** followed by an infinitive to make guesses or express your opinion based on a fact.

Structure:

Affirmative: **Subject + modal verb + verb (base form) + complement.**

Negative: **Subject + modal verb + not + verb (base form) + complement.**

Interrogative: **Modal verb + Subject + verb (base form) + complement + ?**

Examples:

- *To create individual pages designs, **you could keep** in mind the colors and the font type you have been using in the other pages.*
- *I guess **you couldn't wait** until the presentation to show us the new manual.*
- ***Could you tell if** the manual we are about to implement is covering the current issue we have with the software privileges?*

Examples

- *Pictures and diagrams **could also be** good visual aids to keep the style on the pages.*
- *Creators **could try to** draw users' attention from the very beginning by implementing large-sized fonts to highlight important aspects.*

How to Give Instructions

From time to time, you need to provide customers with a set of instructions to illustrate them on how to perform something. Therefore, It is important you learn how to do it.

These are some tips you should take into account when giving instructions:

1. Don't assume your readers know the same you do.
2. Set your goal clear, otherwise your manual will be either too long or too simple.
3. Create a draft, this will help you have a big picture of how it will look.
4. Keep it simple, use table of contents and graphics, they help users understand.
5. Ask someone to read it and give you feedback.
6. Keep it short, do not overwhelm users with lots of information they may not need.

